Mark Scheme (Results)

Summer 2026

Pearson Edexcel GCSE
In History (1HI0)
Paper 3: Modern depth study

Option 33: The USA, 1954-75:
conflict at home and abroad

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General Marking Guidance

- All candidates must receive the same treatment. Examiners must mark the first candidate in exactly the same way as they mark the last.
- Mark schemes should be applied positively. Candidates must be rewarded for what they have shown they can do rather than penalised for omissions.
- Examiners should mark according to the mark scheme not according to their perception of where the grade boundaries may lie.
- There is no ceiling on achievement. All marks on the mark scheme should be used appropriately.
- All the marks on the mark scheme are designed to be awarded. Examiners should always award full marks if deserved, i.e. if the answer matches the mark scheme. Examiners should also be prepared to award zero marks if the candidate's response is not worthy of credit according to the mark scheme.
- Where some judgement is required, mark schemes will provide the principles by which marks will be awarded and exemplification may be limited.
- When examiners are in doubt regarding the application of the mark scheme to a candidate's response, the team leader must be consulted.
- Crossed out work should be marked UNLESS the candidate has replaced it with an alternative response.

How to award marks when level descriptions are used

1. **Finding the right level**

The first stage is to decide which level the answer should be placed in. To do this, use a 'best-fit' approach, deciding which level most closely describes the quality of the answer. Answers can display characteristics from more than one level, and where this happens markers must use the guidance below and their professional judgement to decide which level is most appropriate. For example, one stronger passage at L4 would not by itself merit a L4 mark, but it might be evidence to support a high L3 mark, unless there are substantial weaknesses in other areas. Similarly, an answer that fits best in L3 but which has some characteristics of L2 might be placed at the bottom of L3. An answer displaying some characteristics of L3 and some of L1 might be placed in L2.

2. **Finding a mark within a level**

After a level has been decided on, the next stage is to decide on the mark within the level. The instructions below tell you how to reward responses within a level. However, where a level has specific guidance about how to place an answer within a level, always follow that guidance.

Levels containing two marks only

Start with the presumption that the work will be at the top of the level. Move down to the lower mark if the work only just meets the requirements of the level.

Levels containing three or more marks

Markers should be prepared to use the full range of marks available in a level and not restrict marks to the middle. Markers should start at the middle of the level (or the upper-middle mark if there is an even number of marks) and then move the mark up or down to find the best mark. To do this, they should take into account how far the answer meets the requirements of the level:

- If it meets the requirements *fully*, markers should be prepared to award full marks within the level. The top mark in the level is used for answers that are as good as can realistically be expected within that level.
- If it only *barely* meets the requirements of the level, markers should consider awarding marks at the bottom of the level. The bottom mark in the level is used for answers that are the weakest that can be expected within that level.
- The middle marks of the level are used for answers that have a *reasonable* match to the descriptor. This might represent a balance between some characteristics of the level that are fully met and others that are only barely met.

Indicative content

Examiners are reminded that indicative content is provided as an illustration to markers of some of the material that may be offered by students. It does not show required content and alternatives should be credited where valid.

33: The USA: conflict at home and abroad, c1954–75

Question	
1	Give **two** things you can infer from Source A about the Black Panther Party. **Target**: Source analysis (making inferences). **AO3**: 4 marks.
Marking instructions	
Award 1 mark for each valid inference up to a maximum of two inferences. The second mark for each example should be awarded for supporting detail selected from the source. e.g. • *The Black Panther Party felt that the police did not treat Black people fairly* ***(1)****. They said they wanted to protect the community from police brutality and that they would organise self-defence groups* ***(1)****.* • *The Party wanted justice for Black people* ***(1)****. They said that Black people could not get a fair trial and should be released from prison* ***(1)****.* • *The Party was willing to use violence in self-defence* ***(1)****. They said all Black people should carry weapons in order to defend themselves* ***(1)****.* Accept other appropriate alternatives.	

Question		
2 (a)		Explain why the USA became more involved in the conflict in Vietnam in the years 1954-63. You **may** use the following in your answer: • the domino theory • President Kennedy You **must** also use information of your own. **Target:** Analysis of second order concepts: causation [AO2]; Knowledge and understanding of features and characteristics [AO1]. **AO2:** 6 marks. **AO1**: 6 marks.
Level	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	No rewardable material.
1	**1–3**	• A simple or generalised answer is given, lacking development and organisation. [AO2] • Limited knowledge and understanding of the topic is shown. [AO1]
2	**4–6**	• An explanation is given, showing limited analysis and with implicit or unsustained links to the conceptual focus of the question. It shows some development and organisation of material, but a line of reasoning is not sustained. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is included, showing some knowledge and understanding of the period. [AO1]
3	**7–9**	• An explanation is given, showing some analysis, which is mainly directed at the conceptual focus of the question. It shows a line of reasoning that is generally sustained, although some passages may lack coherence and organisation. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is included, showing good knowledge and understanding of the required features or characteristics of the period studied. [AO1] *Maximum 8 marks for answers that do not address three or more aspects of content.*
4	**10–12**	• An analytical explanation is given which is directed consistently at the conceptual focus of the question, showing a line of reasoning that is coherent, sustained and logically structured. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is precisely selected to address the question directly, showing wide-ranging knowledge and understanding of the required features or characteristics of the period studied. [AO1] *No access to Level 4 for answers that do not address three or more aspects of content.*

Marking instructions

Markers must apply the descriptors above in line with the general marking guidance (page 3).

Performance in AO1 and AO2 is interdependent. An answer displaying **no** qualities of AO2 cannot be awarded more than the top of Level 1, no matter how strong performance is in AO1; markers should note that the expectation for AO1 is that candidates demonstrate both knowledge *and* understanding.

The middle mark in each level may be achieved by stronger performance in either AO1 or AO2.

Indicative content guidance

Answers must be credited according to candidates' deployment of material in relation to the qualities outlined in the mark scheme. While specific references are made in the indicative content below, this does not imply that these must be included; other relevant material must also be credited.

Relevant points may include:

- The USA became involved in Vietnam because Eisenhower believed in the domino theory and felt that if the USA did not stop the spread of communism in Vietnam, it would spread to neighbouring countries.
- In 1961, in an attempt to train villagers to protect their villages from the Vietcong, Kennedy sent in the Green Berets, escalating the US involvement.
- In an attempt to prevent the Vietcong recruiting villagers or getting supplies from them, Kennedy introduced the Strategic Hamlets Program in 1962.
- Eisenhower felt he needed to keep Diem in power, so he increased the number of advisers being sent to train the South Vietnamese army (ARVN).
- To hunt out the Vietcong, counter-insurgency tactics were introduced in 1961 that involved US helicopters and pilots transporting ARVN troops.
- The increasing activity of the Vietcong encouraged the USA to become increasingly involved, e.g. by using chemical weapons to destroy jungle plant cover.

Question		
2 (b)		Explain why there was opposition in the USA to the Vietnam War in the years 1964-75. You **may** use the following in your answer: • the draft system • My Lai massacre (1968) You **must** also use information of your own. **Target:** Analysis of second order concepts: causation [AO2]; Knowledge and understanding of features and characteristics [AO1]. **AO2:** 6 marks. **AO1**: 6 marks.
Level	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	No rewardable material.
1	**1–3**	• A simple or generalised answer is given, lacking development and organisation. [AO2] • Limited knowledge and understanding of the topic is shown. [AO1]
2	**4–6**	• An explanation is given, showing limited analysis and with implicit or unsustained links to the conceptual focus of the question. It shows some development and organisation of material, but a line of reasoning is not sustained. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is included, showing some knowledge and understanding of the period. [AO1]
3	**7–9**	• An explanation is given, showing some analysis, which is mainly directed at the conceptual focus of the question. It shows a line of reasoning that is generally sustained, although some passages may lack coherence and organisation. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is included, showing good knowledge and understanding of the required features or characteristics of the period studied. [AO1] *Maximum 8 marks for answers that do not address three or more aspects of content.*
4	**10–12**	• An analytical explanation is given which is directed consistently at the conceptual focus of the question, showing a line of reasoning that is coherent, sustained and logically structured. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is precisely selected to address the question directly, showing wide-ranging knowledge and understanding of the required features or characteristics of the period studied. [AO1] *No access to Level 4 for answers that do not address three or more aspects of content.*

Marking instructions

Markers must apply the descriptors above in line with the general marking guidance (page 3).

Performance in AO1 and AO2 is interdependent. An answer displaying **no** qualities of AO2 cannot be awarded more than the top of Level 1, no matter how strong performance is in AO1; markers should note that the expectation for AO1 is that candidates demonstrate both knowledge *and* understanding.

The middle mark in each level may be achieved by stronger performance in either AO1 or AO2.

Indicative content guidance

Answers must be credited according to candidates' deployment of material in relation to the qualities outlined in the mark scheme. While specific references are made in the indicative content below, this does not imply that these must be included; other relevant material must also be credited.

Relevant points may include:

- There was opposition from many because of the way in which soldiers were recruited into the army. Many felt that the draft system was unfair; Black Americans and poor whites seemed to be mainly targeted, as college students could avoid the draft.
- Media reports made many Americans feel ashamed of their army's behaviour, e.g. reporting of the My Lai massacre and the use of chemical weapons.
- The impact of the war on ordinary Americans led to opposition, as families across the USA became aware of growing numbers of casualties and deaths from 1965.
- The Tet Offensive (1968) showed the difficulty in defeating the Vietcong and led many to call for the end of the war.
- The cost of the war led to increased taxation in the USA, which created opposition to the war.
- The expansion of the War led to opposition, e.g. when the USA bombed Cambodia and bombed North Vietnam in Operation Linebacker I and II.

Question		
3 (a)		How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into progress in education for Black Americans in the years 1954–62? Explain your answer, using Sources B and C and your knowledge of the historical context. **Target**: Analysis and evaluation of source utility. **AO3**: 8 marks.
Level	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	No rewardable material.
1	**1–2**	• A simple judgement on utility is given, and supported by undeveloped comment on the content of the sources and/or their provenance[1]. Simple comprehension of the source material is shown by the extraction or paraphrase of some content. Limited contextual knowledge is deployed with links to the sources.
2	**3–5**	• Judgements on source utility for the specified enquiry are given, using valid criteria. Judgements are supported by developed comment related to the content of the sources and/or their provenance[1]. Comprehension and some analysis of the sources is shown by the selection and use of material to support comments on their utility. Contextual knowledge is used directly to support comments on the usefulness of the content of the sources and/or their provenance.
3	**6–8**	• Judgements on source utility for the specified enquiry are given, applying valid criteria with developed reasoning which takes into account how the provenance[1] affects the usefulness of the source content. The sources are analysed to support reasoning about their utility. Contextual knowledge is used in the process of interpreting the sources and applying criteria for judgements on their utility.

Notes

1. Provenance = nature, origin, purpose.

Marking instructions

Markers must apply the descriptors above in line with the general marking guidance (page 3).

No credit may be given for contextual knowledge unless it is linked to evaluation of the sources.

No credit may be given for generic comments on provenance which are not used to evaluate source content.

Indicative content guidance

Answers must be credited according to candidates' deployment of material in relation to the qualities outlined in the mark scheme. While specific references are made in the indicative content below, this does not imply that these must be included; other relevant material must also be credited. The grouping of points below does not imply that this is how candidates are expected to structure their answers.

Source B

The usefulness could be identified in terms of the following points which could be drawn from the source:

- The source shows the mob behind Elizabeth Eckford, vividly conveying their aggressive resistance to desegregation in education.
- The source indicates the difficulty facing Black Americans who wanted to integrate and it emphasises the lack of progress in access to education.
- A uniformed man can be seen on the edge of the photograph, making no effort to help Elizabeth Eckford and therefore suggesting that the local authorities did not support integration.

The following points could be made about the authorship, nature or purpose of the source and applied to ascribe usefulness to material drawn from it:

- The photograph was taken for publication in newspapers, suggesting that this was seen as a significant event.
- The photograph captured a key moment and possibly aimed to create sympathy for Elizabeth Eckford.

Knowledge of the historical context should be deployed to support inferences and/or to assess the usefulness of information. Relevant points may include:

- Elizabeth Eckford was one of the 'Little Rock Nine' but she had arrived separately from the others and was therefore isolated.

- President Eisenhower sent federal troops to protect the 'Little Rock Nine' and enforce the Supreme Court's order to desegregate schools.

Source C

The usefulness could be identified in terms of the following points which could be drawn from the source:

- The source shows that Black people felt they had won a victory when James Meredith was admitted to the University of Mississippi.
- It shows that James Meredith was enabled to enrol at the university by the NAACP.
- The source is useful because it suggests that Black people saw this event as a stepping stone to future progress in civil rights.

The following points could be made about the authorship, nature or purpose of the source and applied to ascribe usefulness to material drawn from it:

- Myrlie Evers was a leading civil rights campaigner, so she had an insider's knowledge of events.
- She was being interviewed for a documentary broadcast in 1987, so she could use hindsight to say that this event was a breakthrough.

Knowledge of the historical context should be deployed to support inferences and/or to assess the usefulness of information. Relevant points may include:

- The NAACP had a legal fund that was used in cases such as James Meredith, and Brown v the Topeka Board of Education.
- Media publicity on this issue and others, put pressure on President Kennedy to consider proposing legislation to end segregation in public facilities and public schools.

Question		
3 (b)		Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about progress in education for Black Americans in the years 1954–62. What is the main difference between these views? Explain your answer, using details from **both** interpretations. **Target**: Analysis of interpretations (how they differ). **AO4**: 4 marks.
Level	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	No rewardable material.
1	**1–2**	• Limited analysis of the interpretations is shown by the extraction or paraphrase of some content, but differences of surface detail only are given, or a difference of view is asserted without direct support.
2	**3–4**	• The interpretations are analysed and a key difference of view is identified and supported from them.

Marking instructions

Markers must apply the descriptors above in line with the general marking guidance (page 3).

Indicative content guidance

Answers must be credited according to candidates' deployment of material in relation to the qualities outlined in the mark scheme. The indicative content below is not prescriptive and other relevant material not suggested below must also be credited.

- A main difference is that Interpretation 1 suggests that there had been very little progress in education as it shows that political leaders and the public resisted integration. Interpretation 2, on the other hand, states that there was some progress, as it suggests successes were aided by the NAACP, the Supreme Court, and the Kennedy administration.

Question		
3 (c)		Suggest **one** reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about progress in education for Black Americans in the years 1954-62. You **may** use Sources B and C to help explain your answer. **Target**: Analysis of interpretations (why they differ). **AO4**: 4 marks.
Level	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	No rewardable material.
1	**1–2**	• A simple valid explanation is offered but displaying only limited analysis. Support for the explanation is based on simple undeveloped comment or on the selection of details from the provided material or own knowledge, with only implied linkage to the explanation.
2	**3–4**	• An explanation of a reason for difference is given, analysing the interpretations. The explanation is substantiated effectively.

Marking instructions

Markers must apply the descriptors above in line with the general marking guidance (page 3).

Indicative content guidance

Answers must be credited according to candidates' deployment of material in relation to the qualities outlined in the mark scheme. The indicative content below is not prescriptive. The examples below show different approaches to explaining difference, any one of which may be valid. Other valid material must be credited.

- The interpretations may differ because the authors have given weight to different sources. For example, Source B displays public resistance to integration, providing some support for Interpretation 1, which stresses the lack of progress in education for Black Americans, while Source C talks about Meredith's enrolment as a breakthrough - this gives some support for Interpretation 2, which emphasises that acceptance of Meredith can be seen as a key point in improving access to education.
- The interpretations may differ because the authors have different perspectives. Interpretation 1 is dealing with Southern reactions to key events while Interpretation 2 is covering legal changes.
- They may differ because the authors have a different emphasis – Interpretation 1 is presenting a negative view that there had been little progress whereas Interpretation 2 focuses on positive achievements in gaining access to education.

Question		
3 (d)		How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about progress in education for Black Americans in the years 1954-62? Explain your answer, using **both** interpretations, and your knowledge of the historical context. **Target**: Analysis and evaluation of interpretations. **AO4**: 16 marks. **Spelling, punctuation, grammar and the use of specialist terminology (SPaG)**: up to 4 additional marks.
Level	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	No rewardable material.
1	**1–4**	• Answer offers simple valid comment to agree with or counter the interpretation. Limited analysis of one interpretation is shown by selection and inclusion of some detail in the form of simple paraphrase or direct quotation. Generalised contextual knowledge is included and linked to the evaluation.
2	**5–8**	• Answer offers valid evaluative comment to agree with or counter the interpretation. Some analysis is shown in selecting and including details from both interpretations to support this comment. Some relevant contextual knowledge is included and linked to the evaluation. An overall judgement is given but its justification is insecure or undeveloped and a line of reasoning is not sustained.
3	**9–12**	• Answer provides an explained evaluation, agreeing or disagreeing with the interpretation. Good analysis of the interpretations is shown indicating difference of view and deploying this to support the evaluation. Relevant contextual knowledge is used directly to support the evaluation. An overall judgement is given with some justification and a line of reasoning is generally sustained.
4	**13–16**	• Answer provides an explained evaluation reviewing the alternative views in coming to a substantiated judgement. Precise analysis of the interpretations is shown, indicating how the differences of view are conveyed and deploying this material to support the evaluation. Relevant contextual knowledge is precisely selected to support the evaluation. An overall judgment is justified and the line of reasoning is coherent, sustained and logically structured.
Marks for SPaG		
Performance	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	• The learner writes nothing. • The learner's response does not relate to the question. • The learner's achievement in SPaG does not reach the threshold performance level, e.g. errors in spelling, punctuation and grammar severely hinder meaning.
Threshold	**1**	• Learners spell and punctuate with reasonable accuracy. • Learners use rules of grammar with some control of meaning and any errors do not significantly hinder meaning overall. • Learners use a limited range of specialist terms as appropriate.
Intermediate	**2–3**	• Learners spell and punctuate with considerable accuracy. • Learners use rules of grammar with general control of meaning overall. • Learners use a good range of specialist terms as appropriate.
High	**4**	• Learners spell and punctuate with consistent accuracy. • Learners use rules of grammar with effective control of meaning overall. • Learners use a wide range of specialist terms as appropriate.

Marking instructions

Markers must apply the descriptors above in line with the general marking guidance (page 3).

No credit may be given for contextual knowledge unless it is linked to evaluation of the interpretations.

In all levels, the second sentence relates to analysis and while the rest relate to evaluation. The following rules will apply:

- In Level 1, answers that meet the requirements only in relation to analysis without evidence of evaluation should be awarded 1 mark.
- In other levels, answers that meet the requirements only in relation to analysis (but that also fully meet the descriptors for evaluation of the level below) should be awarded no more than the bottom mark in the level.

Indicative content guidance

Answers must be credited according to candidates' deployment of material in relation to the qualities outlined in the mark scheme. While specific references are made in the indicative content below, this does not imply that these must be included; other relevant material must also be credited. The grouping of points below does not imply that this is how candidates are expected to structure their answers.

The interpretation to be evaluated suggests that there was some progress in education for Black Americans.

Relevant points from the provided material and own knowledge which support the claim made in the interpretation may include:

- Interpretation 2 says that the Supreme Court and NAACP played a significant role in improving access to education for Black Americans.
- Interpretation 2 states that the enrolment of James Meredith at the University of Mississippi encouraged other Black Americans to apply to university and access higher education.
- Eisenhower and Kennedy used the National Guard and federal troops to enforce the decisions of the Supreme Court, for example at Little Rock High School and the University of Mississippi.
- Media coverage of resistance to desegregation put pressure on the Presidents to intervene if the state government continued segregation in schools.
- Robert Kennedy, the President's brother, supported desegregation in schools and on public transport and encouraged President Kennedy to intervene in civil rights issues.

Relevant points from the provided material and own knowledge which counter the view may include:

- Interpretation 1 stresses the lack of progress in civil rights, by showing that the schools in the South remained segregated.
- Interpretation 1 shows that local politicians favoured segregation and acted to prevent desegregation.
- James Meredith had to be protected by reserve US deputy marshals and army troops, throughout his attendance at the university.
- By 1962, so little progress had been made in education that civil rights campaigners planned literacy schemes to support the Freedom Summer.
- Civil rights campaigners often faced violence, and, in many cases, local authorities did not intervene to protect Black people when they tried to access education.

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